UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD
Department of Politics and International Relations

Honour School of Philosophy, Politics and Economics
Honour School of Modern History and Politics

208. POLITICS IN SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA
Academic Year 2026-27

Course Providers: Miles Tendi and Lena Reim

Syllabus

The formal syllabus in the *Examination Decrees and Regulations* states:
Candidates will be required to show knowledge of the politics of the countries of sub-Saharan Africa with respect to their political institutions, political sociology, and political economy. The following topics may be considered: nationalism and decolonization; forms of government, civilian and military; parties and elections; conditions for democracy; ethnicity, religion and gender; structural adjustment; conflict and natural resources; agricultural and land policies; the influence of external agencies.

Content and Structure

There is no firm requirement in the examination to refer to a specific number of countries but students are generally expected to study the politics of at least three African countries in significant detail. They will also read material on other countries relevant to the study of the themes and topics specified in the syllabus. Past examination papers provide a further indication of the range of topics which students may be expected to cover. Students will be given some choice, with guidance from their tutors, as to the countries and topics on which they will write tutorial essays.

In studying African topics, students may draw on reading for their 'core' courses (and strengthen their preparation for the 'core' papers): e.g. International Relations; British Politics and Government in the Twentieth Century; Theory of Politics; Comparative Government; and Political Sociology. Similarly, reading for other 'optional' papers will be relevant to this paper, and vice versa.

The course bibliography covers the following topics

1. Nationalism and Decolonisation
2. Forms of Autocracy: Civilian and Military Rule
3. Parties and Elections
4. Democracy
5. Ethnicity, Class and the Politics of Citizenship
6. Religion
7. Gender
8. The Politics of Economic Reform
9. The Political Economy of the New Authoritarians
10. HIV/AIDS and Public Health Policies
11. Land Reform and Agricultural Policies
12. Conflict and Natural Resources

The bibliography also lists material by country and region: Congo, Rwanda and the Central African region; Ethiopia and the Horn of Africa; Francophone West Africa; Ghana; Kenya; Lusophone Africa; Nigeria; South Africa; Sierra Leone and Liberia; Tanzania; Uganda, Zambia, Zimbabwe. Students should, with guidance from their tutors, draw on both sets of lists to identify appropriate material for essays and class topics.

An additional, selective reading list available on Canvas is provided for the. *inter-collegiate classes*. This identifies the books or articles each student is expected to read in preparation for each class.

Items in the bibliography are most likely to be found at the Social Science Library, although some college libraries have significant Africanist resources of relevance to this course.

Objectives

The aim of the course is to enable students

- to acquire a knowledge and understanding of the recent history and contemporary politics of particular African countries;
- to analyse, compare and contrast the political processes and institutions of African countries and to situate them in their social and economic context;
- to extend their understanding of comparative politics, and particularly of issues common to Africa and other regions they may be studying, of political theory, of political sociology and of international relations by raising relevant questions in the African context;
- to examine the political conditions and consequences of economic development and public policies;
- to provide a foundation for students preparing theses on African topics in Finals.

Teaching Arrangements

Students are expected to attend lectures, to participate in a compulsory inter-collegiate class, and to prepare essays for tutorials. All teaching must be arranged directly with Lena Reim.

Lectures for 2026-27:

HT26: Themes in African Politics

Classes for 2026-27

Classes are held in Hilary Term 2027 for all students taking tutorials for this course in TT26 and MT26. Each student will present one topic to the class.

College tutors should contact Lena Reim about teaching arrangements, ideally before the end of the term preceding the class.

In Hilary Term 2027, classes will take place from 2 to 5 p.m. on Tuesdays from weeks 3-8. Students will be allocated to a class in Week 1 of HT27.

Tutorials 2026-27
Each undergraduate's College tutor will arrange for tutorial teaching by directly contacting the course providers. These will be the only valid tutorial arrangements. Students will attend eight tutorials. They are expected to read background material and write their first essay over the vacation preceding the term in which they take the course. They will write another six tutorial essays each term, in addition to their contributions to classes.

Guest-speaker Seminars for 2026-27 [undergraduates, graduates and staff are welcome; events are listed in the African Studies Centre website)
MT & HT: African Studies seminar (3 p.m., Thursdays at St. Antony's).
MT, HT, TT: The Oxford Central Africa Forum, the Horn of Africa Seminar, the South Africa Discussion Group and the Oxford University China Africa Network also organise guest speaker events throughout the year.

Course Assessment

The course is assessed by means of a three-hour unseen examination according to the provisions established in the *Examination Decrees and Regulations*. Further details are available in the *PPE Handbook* which is available on the DPIR website.

Course bibliography

General

Ake, C. 1996 *Democracy and development in Africa*, Washington, DC: Brookings Institution.
***Arrighi, G**. 2002 "The African Crisis: World Systemic and Regional Aspects", *New Left Review* 15.
***Bayart, J.-F.** 2009 *The State in Africa: Politics of the Belly*, London: Polity OR Bayart, J. -F. 2000 "Africa within the world: a history of extraversion", *African Affairs* 99 (395).
Berman, B., *et al.* 2003 *Ethnicity and Democracy in Africa*, Oxford: James Currey.
Chabal, P. & Daloz, J.-P. 2004 *Africa Works: Disorder as a Political Instrument*, Oxford: James Currey.
Cheeseman, N. 2015 *Democracy in Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Clapham, C.** 1996 *Africa and the international system: the politics of state survival*, Cambridge: CUP.
Clapham, C. 2017 *The Horn of Africa: State Formation and Decay*, London: Hurst.
***Cooper, F.** 2019 *Africa Since 1940*, Cambridge: CUP. (second edition).
***Cornwall, A.** (ed), 2005 *Readings in Gender in Africa*, Oxford: James Currey.
Dwyer, M. & Molony, T. (eds), 2019 *Social Media and Politics in* Africa, London: ZED.
Englebert, P. & Dunn, K. 2019, *Inside African Politics*, Boulder: Lynne Rienner.
Fallon, K. 2008 *Democracy and the Rise of Women's Movements in Sub-Saharan Africa*. Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press.
***Fanon, F.** 2001 *The Wretched of the Earth*, London: Penguin.
***Getachew, A.** 2019 *Worldmaking after Empire*, Princeton: Princeton University Press.
Harkness, K. 2018 *When Soldiers Rebel: Ethnic Armies and Political Instability in Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
Herbst, J. 2000 *States and power in Africa*, Princeton: Princeton University Press.
Jones, W., Soares de Oliveira, R., & Verhoeven, H. 2013 "Africa's Illiberal Statebuilders", *RSC Working Paper Series 89*.
Kalu, K., Olajumoke Y.-H. & Falola, T. (eds) 2018 *Africa's Big Men: Predatory State-Society Relations in Africa*, New York: Routledge.
Lynch, G. 2018 'Ethnicity in Africa', in *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of African History*, Oxford: Oxford University Press. Available at https://oxfordre.com/africanhistory/view/10.1093/acrefore/9780190277734.001.0001/acrefore-9780190277734-e-32
***Mkandawire, T.** 2015 'Neopatrimonialism and the political economy of economic performance in Africa: Critical reflections', *World Politics* 67 (3).
***Mama, A.** 2018 'Colonialism', in Ní Aoláin, Cahn, Haynes & Valji (eds) *The Oxford Handbook of Gender and Conflict* Oxford: OUP. DOI: https://www.oxfordhandbooks.com/view/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780199300983.001.0001/oxfordhb-9780199300983-e-21
Mbah, N. 2019 'African Masculinities', *African History*, Oxford: OUP. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/acrefore/9780190277734.013.270
Mshomba, R. 2000 *Africa in the global economy*, Boulder: Lynne Rienner.
Mudimbe, V. 1988 *The Invention of Africa*, Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
Nugent, P. 2012 *Africa Since Independence*, Basingstoke: Palgrave. (second edition)
***Oloruntoba, S. & Falola, T.** (eds) 2018 *The Palgrave Handbook of African Politics, Governance and Development*, Basingstoke: Palgrave.
***Rabinowitz, B**. 2020 *Coups, Rivals and the Modern State*, Cambridge: CUP.
Reno, W. 2011 *Warfare in Independent Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
Rodney, W. 1988 *How Europe underdeveloped Africa*, London: Bogle-L'Ouverture.
Sahle, E. 2017 *Democracy, Constitutionalism, and Politics in Africa*, London: Palgrave.
Soares de Oliveira, R. 2007 *Oil and Politics in the Gulf of Guinea*, London: Hurst.
***Tripp, A.** 2015 *Women and Power in Post Conflict Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
Vaughan, O. 2005 *Tradition and Politics: Indigenous Political Structures and Governance in Africa*, Africa World Press.
Young, C. 1994 *The African colonial state in comparative perspective*, New Haven: Yale University Press.
Young, T., ed., 2012 *Readings in African Politics*, Oxford: James Currey.

Reference works

- *Africa Confidential* www.africa-confidential.com
- *Africa Contemporary Record: Annual Survey and Documents*
- *Africa South of the Sahara (annual yearbook of facts and country profiles)*
- IES Databases (the *Economist,* the *Financial Times* and *Quest*)
- Oxford Analytica website via SOLO or www.oxweb.com

Main Journals

- Africa (Journal of the International Africa Institute)
- Africa Spectrum
- Africa Today
- African Affairs
- African Studies Review (ASR)
- Canadian Journal of African Studies
- CODESRIA Bulletin
- Feminist Africa
- Journal of African History
- Journal of Contemporary African Studies
- Journal of Democracy
- Journal of Development Studies
- Journal of Eastern African Studies
- Journal of Modern African Studies (JMAS)
- Journal of Southern African Studies (JSAS)
- Politique Africaine
- Review of African Political Economy (ROAPE)
- South African Review
- Third World Quarterly
- World Development

Newspapers and other periodicals

- *Africa Confidential* www.africa-confidential.com
- *Africa Report*
- *Economist*
- *Financial Times*
- *Jeune Afrique*
- *Mail and Guardian (South Africa)*
- *The New York Times*
- *Premium Times (Nigeria)*
- *Le Monde*
- *Weekly Review (Kenya)*
- *Guardian (Nigeria)*

Internet newspapers and other news sources are available from most countries.

The *Mail and Guardian* www.mg.co.za includes a searchable index and archive of articles on specific countries and topics. Africanarguments.org is a useful Internet forum on African politics. In addition, www.allafrica.com provides links to many newspapers and www.africanews.org compiles stories from many different sources, listed by region and country.

NATIONALISM AND DECOLONISATION

Sample questions

1 'Nationalist ideology is as much about forgetting as about remembering aspects of the past'. Discuss.

2. To what extent has post-independence politics been determined by the nature of the liberation struggle?

Key readings

Alexander, J., *et al. 2017 'The Transnational Histories of Southern African Liberation Movements', *JSAS* 43(1).
***Amutabi, M**., 2018 'Nationalism in Africa: Concepts, Types and Phases' in Oloruntoba, Samuel Ojo & Falola, Toyin. (eds), *The Palgrave Handbook of African Politics, Governance and Development*, London: Palgrave Macmillan.
***Berger, I.,** 2016 *Women in Twentieth Century Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Cabral, A.** 1979 *Unity and Struggle: Speeches and Writings*, London: Monthly Review Press.
***Cooper, F.,** 2011 'Alternatives to Nationalism in French West Africa, 1945-60', in Frey, M. & Dülferr, J. (eds), *Elites and Decolonization in the Twentieth Century*, London: Palgrave Macmillan.
*** Fanon, F.** 2001 *The Wretched of the Earth*, London: Penguin.
***Getachew, A.** 2019 *Worldmaking after Empire*, Princeton: Princeton University Press.
***Mkandawire, T.** (ed), 2005 *African Intellectuals: Rethinking Politics, Language, Gender and Development*, Dakar: CODESRIA.
***Southall, R.,** 2016 *Liberation Movements in Power: Party and State in Southern Africa*, Oxford: James Currey.
***White, L. & Larmer, M**, 2014 'Mobile Soldiers and the Un-National Liberation of Southern Africa', *JSAS* 40 (6).

Additional readings

Anderson, B. 2006 *Imagined communities: reflections on the origin and spread of nationalism*, London: Verso.
Anderson, D. 2005 'Yours in Struggle for Majimbo: Nationalism and The Party Politics of Decolonisation in Kenya, 1955-64', *Journal of Contemporary History* 40(3).
Bauer, G & Taylor S. 2011 *Politics in Southern Africa*, London: Boulder.
Beinart, W., 2001 *Twentieth-Century South Africa*, Oxford: OUP.
Bereketeah, R. (ed) 2018 *National Liberation Movements As Government in Africa*, London: Routledge.
Cooper, F. 2019 *Africa since 1940: The Past of the Present*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Dorman, S.** 2019 'Nationalism in African Politics' in *The Oxford Encyclopaedia of African Politics*, https://oxfordre.com/politics/view/10.1093/acrefore/9780190228637.001.0001/acrefore-9780190228637-e-761 **Falola, T.** 2001 *Nationalism and African intellectuals*, Rochester: University of Rochester Press. **Firmin-Sellers, K.** 2000 'Institutions, context and outcomes- explaining French and British rule in West Africa', *Comparative Politics* 32.
Freund, B. 1998 *The Making of Contemporary Africa*, Basingstoke: Macmillan.
Geiger, S. 1997 *Tanu Women: Gender and Culture in the Making of Tanganyikan Nationalism, 1955-1965*, London: Heinemann.
Hastings, A. 1997 *The construction of nationhood: ethnicity, religion and nationalism*, Cambridge: CUP.
Hayes, P. 2014 'Nationalism's Exile: Godfrey Nangonya and SWAPO's Sacrifice in Southern Angola', *JSAS* 40(6).
Hodgkin, T. 1956 *Nationalism in colonial Africa*, London: Muller.
Hunter, E. 2015 *Political Thought and the Public Sphere in Tanzania: Freedom, Democracy and Citizenship in the Era of Decolonization*, Cambridge: CUP.

Iyobi, R. 2008 *Eritrean Struggle for Independence: Domination, Resistance, Nationalism, 1941-1993*, Cambridge: CUP.

Kam Kah, H. 2011 'Women's Resistance in Cameroon's Western Grassfields: The Power of Symbols, Organization, and Leadership,1957-1961', *African Studies Quarterly* 12(3).

Larmer, M & Kennes, E, 2014 'Rethinking the Katangese Secession', *Journal of Imperial and Commonwealth History*, 42(4).

Lonsdale, J. 1990 'Mau Maus of the mind: making Mau Mau and remaking Kenya', *Journal of African History* 31(3).

Mamdani, M. 2001 'Beyond settler and native as political identities: overcoming the political legacy of colonialism', *Comparative Studies in Society and History* 43.

Mandela, N. 1994 *Long walk to freedom: the autobiography of Nelson Mandela*, London: Little Brown.

Mba, N. 1982 *Nigerian Women Mobilised: Women's Political Activity in Southern Nigeria, 1900-1965*, Berkeley: University of California Press.

McCracken, J. 1998 'Democracy and nationalism in historical perspective: the case of Malawi', *African Affairs* 97 (387).

Mudimbe, V. 1988, *The Invention of Africa*, Bloomington: Indiana University Press.

Nhongo-Simbanegavi, J. 2000 *For Better or Worse? Women and ZANLA in Zimbabwe's Liberation Struggle*, Harare: Weaver Press.

Nugent, P. 2012 *Africa Since Independence*, Basingstoke: Palgrave. (second edition)

Raftopoulos, B. & Mlambo, A. (eds) 2009 *Becoming Zimbabwe. A History from the Pre-colonial Period to 2008,* Harare: Weaver Press.

Ranger, T. 1985 *Peasant consciousness and guerrilla war in Zimbabwe*, London: James Currey.

Schmidt, E. 2005 *Mobilizing the Masses: Gender, Ethnicity, and Class in the Nationalist Movement in Guinea, 1939-1958*, London: Heinemann.

Schmidt, E., 2005 'Top Down or Bottom Up? Nationalist Mobilization Reconsidered, with Special Reference to Guinea (French West Africa)', *American Historical Review* 110.

Schmidt, E.. 2007 *Cold War and Decolonization in Guinea, 1946-1958*, Ohio University Press.

Shireen, H., 2014 *The ANC Women's League,* Ohio University Press.

Skinner, K., 2015 *The Fruits of Freedom in British Togoland: Literacy, Politics and Nationalism, 1914-2014*, Cambridge: CUP.

Tendi, B.-M., 2010 *Making History in Mugabe's Zimbabwe: Politics, Intellectuals and the Media* (Peter Lang.

Terretta, M. 2010 'Cameroonian Nationalists Go Global: From Forest Maquis to a Pan-African Accra', *Journal of African History* 51.

Tibenderana, P. 2003 *Education and Cultural Change in Northern Nigeria, 1906-1966*, Kampala: Fountain Publishers.

FORMS OF AUTOCRACY: CIVILIAN AND MILITARY RULE

I: Civilian Rule – Personal Rule and Party Systems

Sample questions:

1. What has enabled certain ruling parties to maintain power since independence?

2. To what extent is 'neo-patrimonialism' a useful way of conceptualizing African

politics? **Key readings**

***Bach, D.**, 2011 'Patrimonialism and Neopatrimonialism: Comparative Trajectories and Readings', *Commonwealth and Comparative Politics* 49 (3).
***Decalo, S.** 1985 'African Personal Dictatorships', *JMAS* 23(2).
***De Jager N. and Du Toit, P.** (eds) 2013 *Friend or Foe? Dominant Party Systems in Southern Africa: Insights From The Developing World*, Cape Town: University of Cape Town Press.
***Kalu, K., Olajumoke Y., & Falola, T.** (eds). 2018 *Africa's Big Men: Predatory State-Society Relations in Africa*, New York: Routledge.
***Pitcher, A., Moran, M. & Johnston, M.**, 2009 'Rethinking Patrimonialism and Neopatrimonialism in Africa,' *ASR* 52(1).
***Oloruntoba, S. & Falola, T. (eds),** 2018 *The Palgrave Handbook of African Politics, Governance and Development*, London: Macmillan.
***Young, C**. 2012 *The Post-colonial State in Africa: 50 Years of Independence, 1960-2010*, Madison: University of Wisconsin.
***Woodward, S.** 2017 *The Ideology of Failed States: Why Intervention Fails*, Cambridge: CUP.

Additional readings

Allen, C. 1995 'Understanding African Politics', *ROAPE* 65.
Assensoh, A. 1998 *African political leadership: Jomo Kenyatta, Kwame Nkrumah, and Julius K. Nyerere*, Malabar: Krieger Publishers.
Bates, R. 2008 *When Things Fell Apart*, Cambridge: CUP.
Bauer, G. & Taylor S., 2011 *Politics in Southern Africa: Transition and Transformation*, London: Boulder.
Bayart, J.-F. 2009 *The State in Africa: Politics of the Belly*, London: Polity (especially Introduction and Chapter 9).
Booth, D. & Golooba-Mutebi, F 2012 'Developmental patrimonialism? The case of Rwanda', *African Affairs* 111(444).
Chabal, P. & Daloz, J.-P. 2004 *Africa Works: Disorder as a Political Instrument*, Oxford: James Currey.
Clapham, C. 2017 *The Horn of Africa: State Formation and Decay*, London: Hurst.
De Simone, S, 2018 'Playing the 'fragile state' card: The SPLM and state extraversion in South Sudan', *JMAS* 56(3).
Erdmann, G. & Engel, U, 2007 'Neo-patrimonialism Reconsidered: Critical review and elaboration of an elusive concept,' *Commonwealth and Comparative Politics* 45(1).
Gertzel, C., et al 1984 *The Dynamics of the one-party state in Zambia*, Manchester: Manchester University Press.
Hagmann, T., & Hoehne, M., 2008 'Failures of the State Failure Debate: Evidence from the Somali territories,' *Journal of International Development* 21(1).
Herbst, J. 2000 *States and Power in* Africa, Princeton: Princeton University Press.
Jackson, R. & Rosberg, C. 1982 *Personal rule in black Africa,* Berkeley: University of California Press.

Lwanda, J. 1993 *Kamuzu Banda of Malawi: a study in promise, power and paralysis*, Bothwell: Nsomba Publications.
Markó, F. 2016 '"We Are Not a Failed State, We Make the Best Passports": South Sudan and Biometric Modernity', *ASR* 59(2).
Mkandawire, T, 2015 'Neopatrimonialism and the Political Economy of Economic Performance in Africa: Critical Reflections', *World Politics* 67(3).
Rathbone, R. 2000 *Nkrumah & the chiefs: the politics of chieftaincy in Ghana, 1951-1960*, Oxford: James Currey.

II: Military Rule

Sample Questions

1. 'Gender is a crucial organising factor in military states'. Discuss.

2. Why, and with what consequences, was the military once seen as 'the most effective supervisory agency for directed change'?

Key readings

***Bienen, H.** (ed), 2009 *The Military and Modernisation*, London: Routledge.
***Decalo, S.** 2000 *Coups and Army Rule in Africa*, New Haven: Yale University Press.
***Decker, A.,** 2014 *In Idi Amin's Shadow: Women, Gender and Militarism in Uganda*, Athens: Ohio University Press.
***Harkness, K.** 2018 *When Soldiers Rebel: Ethnic Armies and Political Instability in Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Kandeh, J.** 2004 *Coups from Below: Armed Subalterns and State Power in West Africa*, New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
***Mama, A.,** 1998 'Khaki in the Family: Gender Discourses and Militarism in Nigeria', *ASR* 41(2).
***McGowan, P.** 2003 'African military coups d'etat, 1956-2001: frequency, trends and distribution', *JMAS* 41 (3).
***Rabinowitz, B**. 2020 *Coups, Rivals and the Modern State*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Schmidt**, **E.,** 2013 *Foreign Intervention in Africa*, Cambridge: CUP (see chapter 7).
***Souare, I.** 2014 'The African Union as a Norm Entrepreneur on Military Coups d'état in Africa (1952–2012): an Empirical Assessment', *JMAS* 52(1).
***Tendi, B-M,** 2020 'The Motivations and Dynamics of Zimbabwe's 2017 Military Coup', *African Affairs* 119(474).

Additional readings

Camara, M. 2000 'From military politicization to militarization of power in Guinea-Conakry', *Journal of Political & Military Sociology* 28(2).
De Bruin, E., 2020 *How to Prevent Coups D'État*, Ithaca: Cornell University Press.
Decalo, S. 2000 *Civil-Military Relations in Africa*, Gainesville: Florida Academic Press.
Finer, S. 2002 *The Man on Horseback: the role of the military in politics,* London: Routledge.
First, R. 1972 *The barrel of a gun: political power in Africa and the coup d'etat*, Harmondsworth: Penguin.
Geddes, B. 2020 'The Consequences of Military Rule: Juntas Versus Strongmen', *The Oxford Encyclopedia of the Military in Politics*, OUP: https://doi.org/10.1093/acrefore/9780190228637.013.1877
Goldsworthy, D. 1986 'On the Structural Explanation of African Military Interventions', *JMAS* 24(1).

Good, K. 2010 'The Presidency of General Ian Khama: The Militarisation of the Botswana "Miracle"', *African Affairs* 109(435).
Huntington, S. 2004 *The Soldier and the State: The Theory and Politics of Civil-Military Relations*, Cambridge: Harvard University Press.
Hutchful, E., & Bathily A. 1998 (eds), *The Military and Militarism in Africa*, Dakar: CODESRIA.
— 1996 'What does the military do when it rules? Gambia, Sierra Leone and Liberia', *ROAPE* 69.
Kieh, G. 2000 'Military rule in Liberia', *Journal of Political & Military Sociology* 28(2).
Koehler, K. & Albrecht H., 2021 'Revolutions and the Military: Endgame Coups, Instability, and Prospects for Democracy', *Armed Forces & Society* 47(1).
Ojo, E. 2009 'Guarding the "Guardians": A Prognosis of Panacea for Evolving Stable Civil- Military Relations in Nigeria', *Armed Forces & Society* 35(4).
— 2006 'Taming the Monster: Demilitarization and Democratization in Nigeria', *Armed Forces & Society* 32(2).
Omorogbe, E. 2012 'A Club of Incumbents? The African Union and Coups d'État', *Vanderbilt Journal of Transnational Law* 44 (123).
Roessler, P. 2011 "The Enemy Within: Personal Rule, Coups and Civil War in Africa", *World Politics* 63 (2).
Rwengabo, S. 2012 'Regime Stability in Post-1986 Uganda: Counting the Benefits of Coup-Proofing', *Armed Forces & Society* 39(3).
Salihu, N., 2020 'Concordance: Civil–Military Relations in Ghana's Fourth Republic', *Armed Forces & Society* 46(4).
Singh, N. 2014 *Seizing Power: the Strategic Logic of Military Coups*, Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press.
Siollun, M. 2019 *Nigeria's Soldiers of Fortune: The Abacha and Obasanjo Years*, London: Hurst.
—2013 *Soldiers of Fortune: Nigerian Politics From Buhari to Babangida*, 1983-1993, Abuja: Cassava Republic Press.
—2010 *Oil, Politics and Violence: Nigeria's Military Coup Culture 1966-1976*, New York: Algora.
Tansey, O., 2017 'The Fading of the Anti-Coup Norm', *Journal of Democracy* 28(1).
Twagira, B., 2016 '"The Men Have Come": Gender and Militarisation in Kampala, 1966–86', *Gender & History* 28(3).
Witt, **A.** 2020 *Undoing Coups: The African Union and Post-Coup Intervention in Madagascar*, London: Zed Books.

PARTIES AND ELECTIONS (see also Conditions of Democracy)

Sample questions

1. 'The advent of multi-party elections has not brought about any fundamental change in the way politics has been conducted.' Discuss.

0. 'Multi-party elections have provided a means for deciding who exercises power but have not laid a foundation for democratic politics'. Discuss.

1. 'Since independence, single party governments have provided the most stable of any forms of rule in sub-Saharan Africa.' Discuss.

Key readings

***Arriola, L.** 2013 "Capital and opposition in Africa: Coalition building in multiethnic societies" *World Politics* 65(2).
***Bleck, J. & De Walle, N.,** 2019 *Electoral Politics in Africa Since 1990: Continuity in Change*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Bob-Milliar, G.** 2012 "Political party activism in Ghana: factors influencing the decision of the politically active to join a political party", *Democratization* 19(4).
***Elischer, S.** 2013 *Political parties in Africa: ethnicity and party formation*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Lupu, N., & Riedl, R.** 2013 "Political parties and uncertainty in developing democracies" *Comparative Political Studies* 46(11).
***Opalo, K**. 2019 *Legislative Development in Africa: Politics and Postcolonial Legacies*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Pitcher, A.** 2012 *Party Politics and Economic Reform in Africa's Democracies*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Resnick, D.** 2012 "Opposition parties and the urban poor in African democracies", *Comparative Political Studies* 45(11).
***Riedl, R.** 2014 *Authoritarian origins of Democratic Party Systems in Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Southall, R.** 2013 *Liberation Movements in Power: Party and State in Southern Africa*, Oxford: James Currey.
***Wahman, M. & Boone, C.** 2018 'Captured countryside? Stability and change in sub-national support for African incumbent parties', *Comparative Politics* 50 (2).

Additional readings

Amoah, M. 2020 "Sleight is right: Cyber control as a new battleground for African elections", *African Affairs* 119 (474).
Angerbrandt, H. 2018 'Deadly elections: post-election violence in Nigeria', *JMAS* 56(1).
Bratton, M., et al. 2012 "Voting intentions in Africa: ethnic, economic or partisan?." *Commonwealth & Comparative Politics* 50(1).
Bogaards, M. 2004 "Counting parties and identifying dominant party systems in Africa." *European Journal of Political Research* 43(2).
Cheeseman, N., & Hinfelaar, M. 2010 "Parties, platforms, and political mobilization: The Zambian Presidential election of 2008", *African Affairs* 109(434).
Elischer, S. 2008 "Do African parties contribute to democracy? Some findings from Kenya, Ghana and Nigeria", *Africa Spectrum* 43(2).
Geisler, G. 2000 "'Parliament is another terrain of struggle": women, men and politics in South Africa', *JMAS* 38(4).
Kriger, N. 2005 'ZANU(PF) Strategies in General Elections: 1980-2000 – Discourse and Coercion', *African Affairs* 104(414).
Koter, D. 2017 'Costly electoral campaigns and the changing composition and quality of parliament: Evidence from Benin', *African Affairs* 116 (465).
LeBas, A. 2013 *From Protest to Parties: Party-Building and Democratization in Africa*, Oxford: OUP.

Manning, C. 2005 "Assessing African party systems after the third wave" *Party Politics* 11(6).
Mugaju, J. & Oloka-Onyango, J. 2000 *No-party democracy in Uganda: myths and realities*, Kampala: Fountain Publishers.
Munro, W. 2001 'The political consequences of local electoral systems: democratic change and the politics of differential citizenship in South Africa', *Comparative Politics* 33(3).
Ndlela, Martin & Mano, W. (eds), 2020 *Social Media and Elections in Africa,* London: Palgrave.
Ngomba, T, 2016 'Social Media and Election Campaigns in Sub Saharan Africa: Insights from Cameroon' in A, Bruns (ed), *The Routledge Companion to Social Media and Politics*, London: Routledge.
Nyong'o, P. 1992 'The one-party state and its apologists', in P. A. Nyong'o (ed) *30 years of independence in Africa: the lost decades?*, Nairobi: Academy Science Publishers.
Olukoshi, A. 1998 *The politics of opposition in contemporary Africa*, Uppsala: Nordiska Afrikainstitutet. **Soderberg, M.** 2018 *Violence in African Elections*, London: ZED Books.
Tendi, B-M., & Cheeseman, N., 2010 "Power-sharing in Comparative Perspective: The Dynamics of Unity Government in Kenya and Zimbabwe", *JMAS* 48(2).

CONDITIONS FOR DEMOCRACY (see also Parties and Elections)
Sample Questions

1. Did structural adjustment programmes help democratic politics to emerge in Africa?

2. To what extent are the institutions of civil society in Africa likely to be guarantors of democracy?

3. Has the democratization movement in Africa been driven more by domestic than by external forces?

Key readings

***Ake, C.** 1991 'Rethinking African democracy', *Journal of Democracy* 2(1).
***Arriola, L.** 2012 *Multi-ethnic Coalitions in Africa: Business financing of opposition election campaigns*, Cambridge: CUP.
Bleck, J. & Van De Walle, N. 2019 *Electoral Politics in Africa Since 1990: Continuity in Change*, Cambridge: CUP.
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***Mustapha, AR & Whitfield, L. (eds)** 2011 *Turning Points in African Democracy*, Rochester, URP.

***Opalo, K**. 2019 *Legislative Development in Africa: Politics and Postcolonial Legacies*, Cambridge:

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Bauer, G. & Britton, H, 2006 *Women in African Parliaments*, Boulder: Lynne Rienner.
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Fallon, K.. 2008 *Democracy and the Rise of Women's Movements in Sub-Saharan Africa*. Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press.
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Ihonvbere, J. 2000 'Politics of constitutional reforms and democratization in Africa', *International Journal of Comparative Sociology* 41(1).
Joseph, R. 1987 *Democracy and prebendal politics in Nigeria: the rise and fall of the Second Republic*, Cambridge: CUP.
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Kabwegyere, T. 2000 *People's choice, people's power: challenges and prospects of democracy in Uganda*, Kampala: Fountain.
Kester, G. & Sidibae, O. 1997 *Trade unions and sustainable democracy in Africa*, Aldershot: Ashgate. **Kirschke, L.** 2000 'Informal repression, zero-sum politics and late Third Wave transitions', *JMAS* 38(3). **Leftwich, A.** 1994 'Governance, the state and the politics of development', *Development and Change* 25. **Lemarchand, R.** 1992 'Uncivil states and civil societies: how illusion became reality', *JMAS* 30(2). **McGregor, J.** 2002 'The politics of disruption: war veterans and the local state in Zimbabwe', *African Affairs* 101(402).
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Mpaisha, C. 2000 'The state of democratization in Zambia', *Journal of Commonwealth & Comparative Politics* 38(3).
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Woodberry, R. 2012 "The missionary roots of liberal democracy", *American Political Science Review* 106(2).

ETHNICITY, CLASS AND THE POLITICS OF CITIZENSHIP

I: Class

Sample questions

1. How can one explain the salience of class in African politics?

2. "Ethnicity rather than class is the dominant feature of African politics".

Discuss. **Key readings**

***Ferguson, J.** 1999 *Expectations of modernity: myths and meanings of urban life on the Zambian Copperbelt*, Berkeley: University of California Press.
***Freund, B.** 1988 *The African Worker*, Cambridge: CUP.
***Lubeck, P.** 1987 *The African bourgeoisie: capitalist development in Nigeria, Kenya, and the Ivory Coast*, Boulder: Lynne Rienner.
***Mueller, L**. 2018 *Political Protest in Contemporary Africa*, Cambridge: CUP.

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Charney, C. 1987 'Political power and social class in the neo-Colonial African State', *ROAPE* 38.
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Kennedy, P. 1988 *African capitalism: the struggle for ascendency*, Cambridge: CUP.
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May, J. 2000 *Poverty and inequality in South Africa: meeting the challenge*, London: Zed Books.
***Nolutshungu, S.** 1990 'Fragments of democracy: reflections on class and politics in Nigeria', *Third World Quarterly* 12(1).
Nyong'o, P. 1983 'The economic foundations of the State in contemporary Africa: stratification and social classes', *Presence Africaine* 127/128.
Raftopoulos, B., Sachikonye, L., 2001 *Striking back: the labour movement and the post-colonial state in Zimbabwe 1980-2000*, Harare: Weaver Press.
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Sklar, R. 1975 *Corporate power in an African state: the political impact of multinational mining companies in Zambia*, Berkeley: University of California Press.
Smith, N. 2000 'What happened to class?' *Environmental Planning* 32(6).
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II: Ethnicity

Sample questions

1. If tribes are invented, why has tribalism proved so pervasive in the politics of African countries?

2. To what extent is ethnic identity a product of administrative institutions and the politics of recent decades?

3. Is 'political tribalism' ever compatible with a robust democratic order?

Key readings

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***Ake, C.** 1993 “What is the Problem of Ethnicity in Africa” *Transformation: Critical Perspectives on Southern Africa* 22.
***Bangura, Y**., 2006 ed., *Ethnic Inequalities and Public Sector Governance*, London: Palgrave.
***Berman, B.** 1998 'Ethnicity, patronage and the African state: the politics of uncivil nationalism', *African Affairs* 97.
***Berman, B., Eyoh, D. & Kymlicka, W.** 2003 *Ethnicity and democracy in Africa*, Oxford: James Currey. ***Ekeh, P.** 1975 'Colonialism and the two publics in Africa', *Comparative Studies in Society and History* 17.
***Hobsbawm, E. & Ranger, T.** 1983 *The invention of tradition*, Cambridge: CUP (Ranger chapter).
***Koter, D.** 2013 "King makers: Local leaders and ethnic politics in Africa", *World Politics* 65(2).
***Posner, D.** 2004 “The Political Salience of Cultural Difference: Why Chewas and Tumbukas Are Allies in Zambia and Adversaries in Malawi”, *American Political Science Review* 98 (4).
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Akinyele, R. T. 2001 'Ethnic militancy and national stability in Nigeria: a case study of the Oodua People's Congress', *African Affairs* 100(401).
Keese, A. 2016 *Ethnicity and the Colonial State*, Leiden: Brill.
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Ibelema, M. 2000 'Nigeria: the politics of marginalization', *Current History* 99(637).
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RELIGION

Sample questions

1. 'Religion is fast replacing ethnicity as the central organizing principle of African politics'.

2. 'Clashes between Moslems and Christians, and within each religion, have more to do with struggles over political and economic resources than with conflicts over doctrine and faith.'

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***Ellis, S. & ter Haar, G.** 1998 'Religion and politics in Sub-Saharan Africa', *JMAS* 36(2) OR 2004, *Worlds of Power. Religious Thought and Political Practice in Africa*, London: Hurst.
***Gifford, P.** 1998 *African Christianity: its public role*, London: Hurst.
***Obadare, E**. 2018 *Pentecostal Republic*: *Religion and the Struggle for State Power in Nigeria,* London: University of Chicago Press.
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Anderson, D. & Johnson, D. 1995 *Revealing prophets: prophecy in Eastern African history*, London: James Currey.
Behrend, H. & Cohen, M. 1999 *Alice Lakwena & the Holy Spirits: war in Northern Uganda, 1985-97*, Athens: Ohio University Press.
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Ibrahim, J. 1989 'Politics of religion in Nigeria', *ROAPE* 45/46.
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Kassimir, R. 1998 'The social power of religious organisation and civil society: the Catholic Church in Uganda', in N. Kasfir (ed) *Civil society and democracy in Africa*, London: Frank Cass.
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Kuperus, T. 1999 'Building Democracy: an examination of religious associations in South Africa and Zimbabwe', *JMAS* 37(4).
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Maxwell, D. 2000 'Catch the cockerel before dawn: pentacostalism and politics in post-colonial Zimbabwe', *Development and Change* 31.
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Mustapha, A. R. (ed) 2014 *Sects and Social Disorder: Muslim Identities & Conflict in Northern Nigeria*. Rochester: Boydell and Brewer Ltd.
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Ranger, T. 1985 'Religious movements and politics in Sub-Saharan Africa', *ASR* 29.
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GENDER

Sample questions:

1. "Gender politics has influenced the language but never challenged the prevalent styles of male political rule and resistance in Africa." Discuss.

2. What does a gender perspective reveal about political processes in Africa?

3. 'Women's organisations in Africa have proved ineffective in advancing the gender interests of women'. Discuss.

Key readings:

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***Bauer, G. & Britton, H.** 2006 (Eds) *Women in African Parliaments*, Boulder: Lynne Rienner.
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***Cornwall, A,** 2005 *Readings in Gender in Africa*, Oxford, James Currey.
***Decker, A.,** 2014 *In Idi Amin's Shadow: Women, Gender and Militarism in Uganda*, Athens: Ohio University Press.
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***Tamale, S.** 1999 *When hens begin to crow: gender and parliamentary politics in Uganda*, Boulder: Westview.
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***Tripp, A. M., & Kang, A.** 2008 "The global impact of quotas on the fast track to increased female legislative representation" *Comparative Political Studies* 41 (3).
***Valdini, M**. 2019 *The Inclusion Calculation: Why Men Appropriate Women's Representation,* Oxford: OUP.
`***Tripp, A. M.** 2001 'The politics of autonomy and co-optation in Africa: the case of the Ugandan Women's Movement', *JMAS* 39(1).

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Ajayi, K. 2010 *The Concept of First Lady and Politics in Nigeria*, Dakar: CODESRIA.
Alidou, O. 2005 *Engaging Modernity: Muslim Women and the Politics of Agency in Postcolonial Niger*, Madison: University of Wisconsin Press.
Aubrey, L. 2001 'Gender, development and democratization in Africa', *Journal of Asian and African Studies* 36(1).
Bowman, C., & Kuenyehia, A., 2003 *Women and Law in Sub-Saharan Africa*, Accra: Sedco.
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Dorkenoo, E., 2006 *Female Genital* Mutilation, London: Hurst.
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Connell, R. 2020. *Masculinities*, Cambridge: Polity.
Cornwall, A (ed), 2005 *Readings in Gender in Africa*, Oxford: James Currey.
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Goebel, A. 2006 *Gender and Land Reform: The Zimbabwe Experience*, Montreal: McGill University Press.
Goetz, A. 1998 'Women in politics and gender equality in policy: South Africa and Uganda', *ROAPE* 76.
Hudson, N, 2018 'Gender and the State', *Oxford Encyclopaedia of International Studies*, Oxford, OUP: https://oxfordre.com/internationalstudies/view/10.1093/acrefore/9780190846626.001.0001/acrefore-9780190846626-e-442
Ikelegbe, A., 2005 'Engendering civil society: oil, women groups and resource conflicts in the Niger Delta region of Nigeria', *JMAS* 43 (2).
Imam, A., *et al.* 1997 *Engendering African social sciences*, Dakar, Senegal: CODESRIA.
Lawless, J. & Fox, R. 1999 'Women candidates in Kenya: political socialization and representation', *Women and Politics* 20(4).
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Meagher, K. 2000 'Veiled conflicts: peasant differentiation, gender and structural adjustment in Nigeria Hausaland', in D. Bryceson *et al* (eds) *Disappearing peasantries?* London: Intermediate Technology.
Medie, P. & Kang, A. 2018 'Power, Knowledge and the Politics of Gender in the Global South', *European Journal of Politics and Gender*, 1(1-2).
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Links to Digital Materials

African Women's Rights Observatory: comprehensive source on African women's rights.

Feminist Africa: provocative African scholarship attuned to feminist agendas.

International Idea: a resource supporting democracy worldwide and including an initiative on gender and democracy.

Inter-Parliamentary Union: database on women in national parliaments.

UN Women: gateway to United Nations resources on women.

THE POLITICS OF ECONOMIC REFORM

Sample questions

1. 'The new colonialism'. Is this an appropriate description of the relations of the international agencies with African governments since the early 1980s?

2. If the power of international financial institutions over African economies derived from the African crisis in the 1980s and 1990s, why has structural adjustment continued since the turn of the century?

Key readings

***Arrighi, G**. 2002 "The African Crisis: World Systemic and Regional Aspects", *New Left Review* 15.
***Bates, R.** 1981 *Markets and states in tropical Africa: the political basis of agricultural policies*, Berkeley: University of California Press.
*** Fjeldstad, O. & Moore, M.** 2009 "Revenue authorities and public authority in sub-Saharan Africa" *JMAS* 47(1).
***Goldsmith, A**. 2001 "Foreign Aid and Statehood in Africa", *International Organization* 55 (1).
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***Mkandawire, T.** 1999 'The political economy of financial reform in Africa', *Journal of International Development* 11(3).
*—2015 'Neopatrimonialism and the political economy of economic performance in Africa: Critical reflections', *World Politics* 67 (3).
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***Van de Walle, N.** 2001 *African economies and the politics of permanent crisis, 1979-1999*, New York: CUP.
***Whitfield, L. & Fraser, A.** 2009 A. eds. *The Politics of Aid*, Oxford: OUP.
***Rodrik, D**. 2006 'Goodbye Washington Consensus, Hello Washington Confusion: A Review of the World Bank's Economic Growth in the 1990s', *Journal of Economic Literature* (XLIV).
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THE POLITICAL ECONOMY OF THE NEW AUTHORITARIANS (see also Structural Adjustment and the Politics of Economic Reform *and* Conditions for Democracy)

Sample questions

1. How useful is the notion of 'hybrid regimes' when discussing Africa's dominant party states?

2. Are there 'developmental' authoritarian regimes in Africa?

3. 'In Africa, power is concentrated in the hands of one individual while the indigenous private sector remains weak.' Discuss.

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HIV/AIDS AND PUBLIC HEALTH POLICIES

Sample Questions

1."The obstacles to effective public health responses in African states are primarily political rather than capacity-related". Discuss.

2. How can we explain differences in the prevalence of HIV/AIDS across sub-Saharan Africa?

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LAND REFORM AND AGRICULTURAL POLICY

I: Land Reform

Sample questions

1. Using examples from particular areas of policy, account for the relative successes and failures of development policies in one or more African countries.

2. How successful have land distribution programmes been in any ex-settler country you have studied?

3.'A betrayal of the peasantry': Is this a fair portrayal of land reform programmes in Africa?

Key readings

***Alexander, J.** 1993 'State, peasantry and resettlement in Zimbabwe', *ROAPE* 61.
***Alexander, J**. 2007 J. *The Unsettled Land*, Oxford: James Currey.
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II: Agricultural Policies

Sample questions

1 Is it the case that the success or failure of agricultural policies in Africa depends primarily upon political factors?

2. The weak performance of African agriculture under structural adjustment has led to a policy vacuum. Discuss.

3. "Africa continues to rely on food imports despite myriad attempts at agricultural reform".

Discuss. **Key readings (see also Land reform)**

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***Bates, R.** 1981 *Markets and states in tropical Africa: the political basis of agricultural policies*, Berkeley: University of California Press.
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***Bryceson, D**. 1999 'African rural labour, income diversification and livelihood approaches: a long-term development perspective', *ROAPE* 80.
***Nyerere, J.** 1968 "The Arusha declaration' and 'Socialism and rural development", in J. K. Nyerere (ed) *Freedom and socialism = Uhuru na ujamaa: a selection from writings and speeches, 1965-1967*, Dar es Salaam: Oxford University Press.

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Williams, G. 1985 'Marketing with and without marketing boards', *ROAPE* 34.
— 1998 'Liberalising markets and reforming land in South Africa', *Journal of Contemporary African Studies* 16.

CONFLICT AND NATURAL RESOURCES

Sample Questions:

1. Can the thesis of 'greed and grievance' explain violent political conflicts in Africa?

2. "Discounting the personal motivations of participants in civil conflict impoverishes our understanding of wars in contemporary Africa". Discuss.

3. What is the connection between the exploitation of mineral resources and political and economic turmoil in Africa?

Key readings

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APPENDIX ON INDIVIDUAL REGIONS/COUNTRIES

CONGO, RWANDA AND THE GREAT LAKES REGION

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FRANCOPHONE WEST AFRICA

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